

compliment the seriousness on the site. Being *Digitians*, we were also very pleased with the “geek” factor of the site.

6.2 Specific Course Oriented Websites

Gone are the days when distance learning required you to log onto a Web site, book in one hand, trying to comprehend what the “lecturer” was saying over a chat-room on the Internet, full of “students” chatting to each other in the room. These days social networking sites have forayed into this domain to cash in on the freely available user content to keep their courses up-to-date and providing that additional personal touch to their “students”.

6.2.1 WhyVille (<http://www.whyville.net>)

A 3D, virtual education site geared towards preteens and teenagers, Whyville’s goal is to teach its users about the values of science, business and entrepreneurship through various games and role-play which are available on the Web site. The game is reported to be one of the most popular virtual worlds on the Internet with an online player base of 2.27 million users. There is also an events notice board which lets you socialize with other WhyVille users on the site.



These days, kids have all the fun!

Logging in

To access Whyville, the user has to first make an avatar of him/her. Once that is created, the user can then go about participating in the games on the site which teach its users key real life skills. You can do a lot more once you have registered for a free account on the